One of the committee members said, "Aren't you a premed, Asimov?"

"I was," I said, "but chemistry has always been my choice in case I didn't get into medical school. I didn't try very hard to get into medical school; I only applied to five places."

"And if you take graduate chemistry courses, is that just a way of marking time till you apply for medical school again?"

(Aha, that was what they were holding against me.)

I said, as firmly and as bluntly as I could, "No, sir. I'm in chemistry permanently."

(That was a white lie. I suspected I would have to apply to medical school again to satisfy my father, but I had no doubt that I would be rejected again. I was quite positive it was chemistry for good.)

There was a bit more quizzing and then I was sent out while they considered my case. I think that by now Lloyd Roth was haunting the place just to see what happened to me.

"What happened?" he said.

"They're thinking."

"What happens if they decide against you?"

"Figure out something and come back."

(Actually, I was running out of hope, but I had to keep up my spirits somehow. Roth sat down to wait with me.)

I was called in and Urey said, "All right, Asimov, we're giving you your chance."

Then he explained the terms. It was rather like Dr. Caldwell's suggestion of two months before, and I suspect it was she who had pushed for it.

The terms weren't easy. I wouldn't be allowed to take physical chemistry alone; nor could I fill the term out with peripheral courses, spending money but marking time and allowing myself to concentrate on the essential topic. I would have to take a full collection of graduate courses, along with physical